Purchase and Consumption Orientations Among Filipino Millennials Toward Luxury Brands: Brand Attitude as Mediated by Actual and Ideal Self-Congruity

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Abstract

The present investigation sought to examine the underlying motivations driving Filipino millennials' orientations toward the acquisition and utilization of luxury brands. Extensive scholarly work conducted across various nations, demographic categories, and diverse cultural frameworks has generated substantial knowledge and perspectives regarding consumer viewpoints on luxury brands and their purchase and use. The central focal point of this investigation is the orientation of Filipino millennials with respect to their actual and ideal self-congruity as it pertains to luxury brand attitude — specifically, an examination of the factors that drive or shape Filipino millennials in the acquisition and utilization of luxury brands. In addition, supplementary dimensions of materialistic and status values were scrutinized in relation to the degree to which they exert influence over consumer motivation. Research questions and investigative hypotheses were addressed and resolved through a quantitative research framework. A structured survey questionnaire was administered to university students, young graduates, and young professionals categorized as millennials across various organizations, constituting the primary data-gathering instrument. The investigation revealed that, notably, the motivation reflecting Filipino millennial consumers' orientation toward ideal self-congruency surpasses the influence of actual self-congruity on their brand attitudes toward luxury brands. This influence is clearly discernible among respondents in terms of their orientation toward materialistic value and prestige value. The study's implications are expected to contribute a body of knowledge to both business and academic domains. The findings of the research will constitute a scientific basis for comprehending the brand orientation of Filipino millennials, who comprise approximately one-third of the country's aggregate population and represent nearly half of the labor force. The variables examined in this investigation were not subjected to in-depth study within the Philippine context. Furthermore, the results are anticipated to be of utility to luxury brand managers requiring direction in the selection of appropriate marketing mix elements and marketing strategies when targeting millennial consumer segments.

Keywords: consumer attitude, luxury brand, Filipino millennials, actual & ideal self-congruity, purchase and consumption, motivational factors

**** Paper presented at the International Conference on Marketing, Tourism and Hospitality ICT19Las Vegas Conference, Las Vegas, USA. May 24–26, 2019*

Introduction

As tracked by Bain, the luxury industry encompasses both luxury goods and experiences, comprising nine distinct segments led by luxury automobiles, luxury hospitality, and personal luxury goods, which together account for upwards of 80% of the total market. Overall, the luxury

market expanded 5% in 2018 to an estimated €1.2 trillion globally, with favorable performance observed across most segments. Sales of luxury cars continued to dominate the market, growing 5% at constant exchange rates to €495 billion. Luxury experiences remained highly attractive to consumers, as evidenced by sales growth in luxury hospitality (up 5% from the prior year), gourmet food and fine dining (up 6%), and luxury cruises (up 7%). Moreover, online purchases reached an 8% market share and overall discounted sales reached 37% of the total market (D'Arpizio et al., 2016). Purchases of luxury brands from among younger generational cohorts — generation-y or millennials, i.e., individuals born in the 1980s and 1990s — have increased considerably, as this group assigns value to luxury products at an earlier age than conventional luxury consumers did (The Economist, 2014).

Their purchasing behavior is markedly distinct, characterized by greater spontaneity, experimentation, and a tendency to explore emerging brands — constituting a sharp contrast to traditional luxury consumers, who display more predictable expenditure patterns and brand loyalty (Jay, 2012). It is projected that by 2026, millennials will constitute the primary consumers of luxury goods; accordingly, managers must adapt their marketing and brand management strategies to effectively capture this expansive and rapidly expanding consumer segment in order to outperform competitors (The Economist, 2014).

Brand is a central consideration in consumer decision-making. Nevertheless, a limited body of research currently exists regarding the determinants of luxury consumption and the management of luxury brands. The relationship between consumer perception of luxury and what motivates customers to purchase luxury brands, in particular, remains poorly understood and is largely unexplored (Hennigs et al., 2013). This situation is characteristic of the Philippine context. Luxury brands are capable of satisfying consumers' psychological and functional needs through a combination of four value dimensions: financial, operational, individual, and social (Wiedmann et al., 2007). Based on these four distinct luxury value dimensions, customers may be segmented by distinguishing personally oriented from socially oriented consumers — that is, whether luxury brand acquisition is driven by personal enjoyment or by a desire to demonstrate success (Kapferer & Bastien, 2009). Therefore, luxury brands must deliver value that aligns with customers' subjective expectations and individual perceptions (Hennigs et al., 2013).

Millennials are currently the focus of numerous scholarly investigations, representing a perplexing phenomenon to preceding human generations. This generation is socially interconnected and deeply engaged with social media and information and communication technology applications and infrastructure.

Approximately one-third of Filipinos are millennials, with an age range spanning 15 to 35 years. This generational cohort shares common values and identities expressed across multiple layers. Accordingly, varying versions of the millennial identity emerge depending on how individuals wish to present themselves to the world. Within this framework, brands are encouraged to engage more deeply with millennials and to convert them into affiliates. Consistent with this orientation, millennials tend to adhere to integrity grounded in shared experience rather than positional authority (http://pana.com.ph/decoding-millennials/).

Literature Review

Luxury is a widely employed term for which no universally accepted definition exists. What constitutes luxury for certain individuals may not do so for others (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

Nevertheless, specific attributes are commonly employed to define luxury, encompassing: exceptional quality, elevated price, scarcity and distinctiveness, aesthetics and polysensuality, ancestral heritage and personal history, and superfluousness (Dubois et al., 2001).

Luxury is not synonymous with fashion or premium, despite the conceptual linkages and borrowed associations among these domains (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014: 35). However, possession of only a single attribute from the aforementioned list — such as elevated price — is insufficient by itself to constitute luxury. Consequently, upper-range branded premium products are frequently conflated with luxury. Whereas pricing in premium products is determined by functionality, performance, and quality, in luxury goods it is associated with scarcity, brand identity, and narrative (Turunen, 2015). On the other hand, numerous luxury brands adopt behavioral characteristics of fashion brands, while fashion itself aspires to membership in the luxury domain in order to elevate its standing (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

Luxury products are associated with the notion of a dream, while essential products correspond to need; intermediate to these are branded products, which correspond to desire that is transient and substitutable. Dreams transcend requirements or wants, and it is to dreams that luxury products respond — a quality that distinguishes luxury from non-luxury offerings (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014). The acquisition of a luxury product is tantamount to purchasing into a dream, and such acquisitions are frequently impulsive, emotionally driven, or extravagant (Dubois & Paternault, 1995). Consequently, luxury constitutes an industry characterized by elevated profitability, with high margins in luxury product pricing, and strong brand equity and brand renown generating supplementary value for expensive, premium-quality products (Kapferer, 1997).

Luxury brands may be categorized according to their degree of luxury — i.e., the level of accessibility — classified as accessible, intermediate, and inaccessible luxury brands (De Barnier et al., 2011). Other proposed categorizations of luxury degree, derived from prior literature (Vigneron & Johnson, 1999; Kapferer, 2008; Corbellini & Saviolo, 2009), are summarized in Figure 2 (Turunen, 2015: 122). Brand extensions of luxury brands into new product categories have introduced further ambiguity in defining luxury. When luxury brands launch lower-end extensions, consumers are afforded access to the luxury brand at this accessible product tier — for instance, through fragrances (Patrick & Prokopec, 2015). To comprehend consumer motivations for purchasing luxury, it is imperative to understand the underlying value that the product holds for the consumer at the point of use (Ballantyne & Varey, 2006). Consumers engage with products in varied ways, and the interpersonal and personal dimensions of consumption differ across luxury consumer types (Holt, 1995). Consumers aspire to construct a meaningful existence in relation to personal identity and social relationships, such that the products consumed enhance their individual quality of life through the gratification derived from owning and using products and experiences (Pollay, 1983; Solomon et al., 2016). Consumer perception of luxury brands accordingly shapes the relevance of consumption. In order to comprehend how consumers individualize their perceptions of luxury and how luxury brands alter their daily lives, consumers' consumption values warrant examination (Seo & Buchanan-Oliver, 2014).

According to Kapferer and Bastien (2014), luxury consumers may be divided into heavy users and occasional users. Until approximately the year 2000, growth in the luxury market was attributable largely to a substantial volume of middle-class consumers making occasional luxury purchases. More recently, the primary volume of luxury acquisitions has originated from consumers who purchase frequently. Western middle-class segments are increasingly apprehensive about their

futures and, consequently, perceive themselves as less affluent, migrating toward lower consumption categories, while wealthy purchasers have maintained their optimism, constituting the majority of the luxury market. This market polarization has enabled luxury brands to grow sales of entry-level masstige products among middle-class consumers who have retained their aspirations but are now more deliberate in their spending. By contrast, young Chinese middle-class consumers diverge from their Western counterparts in that, despite possessing considerably less wealth, their incomes are perceptibly increasing, generating a sense of greater optimism and prosperity and rendering the Chinese luxury market highly dynamic. A comparable dynamic may explain the growing number of generation-y consumers purchasing luxury — particularly following the 2008 economic recession — as they increasingly seek self-indulgence through luxury consumption (Jay, 2012).

In research conducted by Kapferer (1998) with an international sample of affluent young consumers, four types of luxury clients were identified on the basis of what luxury signifies to them and what product characteristics they prioritize. The first group prizes the beauty, excellence, and uniqueness of luxury products. The second segment emphasizes creativity and sensuality as the primary luxury values. The third group bases luxury value on timelessness and international reputation, thus perceiving luxury as a reliable choice. The fourth group focuses on rarity and the most inaccessible products, comprising the buyers of the most costly items. It was further observed that the fourth group consisted predominantly of males, while the second segment was predominantly female. This distinction may offer some indication of differences in luxury consumption value preferences between males and females, suggesting that males are more inclined to consume conspicuous markers of success, while females place greater emphasis on creativity, sensuality, and aesthetics. In this regard, younger males tend to consume status signifiers to communicate their progress. The third group of consumers is driven by active and visible cues and widely recognized brand names, while the second group is more concerned with expressing individuality. The first group regards themselves as connoisseurs, aesthetes, and individuals capable of appreciating exceptional craftsmanship.

An alternative segmentation of luxury consumers was proposed by Han et al. (2010). This study advances the analysis of consumers' motivational factors, distinguishing consumers on the basis of the role that brand prominence plays in status signaling — specifically, the conspicuousness of the logo displayed on a product. The greater a consumer's need for status, the more prominently they employ these so-called loud signals of brand affiliation in their consumption behavior. The inverse holds for individuals with a diminished need for status. Consumers with high wealth and a lesser need for status instead signal to one another through quiet, understated brand cues, with logos not prominently displayed, and their premium-priced luxury products are recognized by others within the same consumer segment. Conversely, affluent consumers with a pronounced need for status employ conspicuous luxury products to signal to the less affluent that they do not belong to the same category. The less affluent with high status needs, unable to afford genuine items, consume highly conspicuous — largely counterfeit — luxury products in an attempt to emulate the more affluent and to be perceived as occupying a higher social stratum. Consumers can be influenced by their reference group, by those whom they aspire to resemble, and by those with whom they do not wish to be associated (Han et al., 2010).

According to Veblen (1965), the accumulation of wealth does not in itself confer status; rather, it is the visible evidence of wealth that confers status. This observation illuminates the conspicuous consumption of luxury as a symbolic representation of one's success. Individuals frequently

evaluate others through the objects those individuals consume, and tend to regard their own possessions as extensions of themselves. Furthermore, individuals may employ personal belongings — particularly luxury products — to assist in self-definition and to reflect their own identity. An individual may consume products to convey a distinct sense of selfhood or to signal belonging to a particular social group. Through material possessions, individuals pursue happiness and preserve memories of experiences, accomplishments, and significant relationships. Possessed objects communicate a sense of historical continuity, reflecting who one is, where one originated, and where one is headed (Belk, 1988).

Not all brands are equally luxurious, and, as previously noted, luxury does not possess a singular, unambiguous definition. Furthermore, the degree of luxury attributed to a given brand may be perceived differently across product categories and situational contexts. For instance, Cartier may be accorded a higher perceived luxury in the jewelry category and a comparatively lower perceived luxury in the apparel or fragrance category. In a similar vein, Rolls-Royce is recognized as a luxury brand in the automotive category but is not regarded as such in the context of aircraft engines (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004; Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

To facilitate the differentiation of luxury brands, Vigneron and Johnson (2004) developed a valuation model for assessing the degree of luxury embodied in a given brand. This Brand Luxury Index (BLI) is composed of five perceived dimensions of a luxury brand (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004: 488). The framework incorporates three non-personal perceptions — perceived conspicuousness, perceived uniqueness, and perceived quality — as well as two personally oriented perceptions: perceived hedonism and the perceived extended self. According to Vigneron and Johnson (2004), these five dimensions constitute the essential luxury attributes that must be established and sustained for a luxury brand to endure. A brand is required to manage both personal and interpersonal perceptions to ensure the long-term financial success of a luxury brand (Kapferer & Bastien, 2014).

Moreover, these five core perceptual dimensions are interrelated and underlie consumer decision-making processes when evaluating luxury brands. While consumers assign value to all five dimensions, certain aspects carry differential significance for different consumer profiles. The BLI scale may also be employed to compare distinct luxury brands and, accordingly, to identify competitive advantages within the targeted market (Vigneron & Johnson, 2004).

Berthon et al. (2009) assert that consumers' perceptions of luxury brands encompass three value dimensions: functional, experiential, and symbolic. Vickers and Renald (2003) further contend that a fundamental distinction exists between these three dimensions for luxury versus non-luxury brands, given that consumers hold higher expectations of luxury brands. Because these three luxury value dimensions are contextual in nature, they may evolve over time in accordance with individual and socio-cultural orientations, and are thus co-constructed between a luxury brand and its consumers (Tynan et al., 2010).

The functional value dimension refers to the material representation of an object along with its core benefit and essential utilities — encompassing quality, functionality, reliability, durability, and craftsmanship. Within this dimension, quality is of particular significance as an indicator of product performance and functional capability.

The experiential value dimension embodies individual subjective value, referencing personal taste and the hedonic value an individual derives from a brand. This dimension may be evoked by brand

experience-related stimuli that are embedded in brand identity — including design, packaging, communication, and environmental elements — which collectively influence consumers' sensations, emotions, cognitions, perceptions, and behavioral responses (Berthon et al., 2009). Hence, luxury products deliver need- or want-satisfying consumption experiences (Holbrook, 1999). The perception of luxury as rare, precious, and distinctive may guide individual thoughts and feelings toward a luxury brand through uniqueness-seeking motivations, in addition to hedonic motivations (Hung et al., 2011). Experiential value therefore addresses the question of what the brand signifies to the individual consumer.

The symbolic value dimension pertains to what the brand communicates to others and to the brand's symbolic function within the social collective (Berthon et al., 2009). Symbolic value connotes conspicuousness, costliness, and affluence (Hung et al., 2011). It is of particular importance for premium-priced products and services, given that symbolic attributes embody the aspirational dream and brand narrative. An aspect of symbolic value concerns what the luxury brand signals to others about the consumer — i.e., other-directed signaling, such as the communication of wealth, prestige, achievement, or personal style (Berthon et al., 2009). The symbolic dimension also encompasses a self-directed value component: the significance of the signal to the sender, as an extension of one's self and conspicuousness (Belk, 1988). However, a brand's symbolic value is operative only within communities in which it is recognized; its social utility diminishes when one moves outside such communities.

Symbolic value constitutes a particularly significant consideration for the management and marketing of global luxury brands, as social influence shapes purchase intention — particularly among socially oriented consumers (Tsai, 2005). Luxury brands are required to manage all three of these dimensions effectively and must avoid excessive focus on any single dimension at the expense of the others. For instance, the quality of a luxury brand should not be compromised in favor of an overemphasis on symbolic attributes. Luxury brands ought to represent a convergence of material (objective, functional), individual (subjective, experiential), and social (collective, symbolic) spheres (Berthon et al., 2009).

Wiedmann et al. (2007) have developed a conceptual framework demonstrating that financial, functional, individual, and social dimensions collectively influence consumers' luxury value perception and consumption behavior. These four primary luxury value dimensions are strongly correlated but not identical, and each contributes to consumers' overall luxury value perception. The sub-dimensions of these four primary dimensions of luxury value perception are as follows: price value (financial value); usability value, quality value, and uniqueness value (functional values); self-identity value, hedonic value, and materialistic value (individual values); and conspicuousness value and prestige value (social values). Even when the overall luxury level of a brand is perceived similarly, the core luxury value dimensions are interpreted differently by distinct consumer segments. The luxury value model of Wiedmann et al. (2007) facilitates an understanding of the determinants and drivers of luxury perception, and by extension, of consumer behavior, thereby contributing to the creation, marketing, and monitoring of luxury brands.

In general, the Wiedmann et al. (2007) model is considered the most complex and comprehensive framework available. However, drawing upon various preceding studies on the topic, additional values may warrant incorporation. For instance, Ciornea et al. (2011) have supplemented the financial value dimension with investment value and the functional value dimension with heritage value. Multiple sub-dimensions could be added to the proposed model, such as superfluousness —

which is closely related to the degree of materialism (Ciornea et al., 2011). Furthermore, the individual value and social value dimensions, along with consumers' overall perceived luxury value and luxury brand purchase intention, and the value dimensions that must be accounted for, will be examined in greater detail in subsequent sections and in the research proper.

Filipino millennials exhibit a pronounced dependence on technological devices, which exerts a notable financial strain on their resources; to a certain extent, they employ information and communication technology to economize and access discounts on airline tickets, food packages, travel promotions, and related offerings.

Research conducted by Visa revealed that 80% of Filipino millennials favor cash-based transactions over credit card usage. The results further indicated that Filipino millennials harbor reservations regarding the credit card system, attributable to concerns over confidentiality and data security. Accordingly, the promotion of financial literacy concerning credit card usage is considered necessary (https://www.ecomparemo.com/info/who-are-the-filipino-millennials-and-what-are-their-spending-habits/).

According to Madelaine B. Miraflor, the purchasing power of millennials is rapidly escalating, as manifested in their acquisition of personal care products, home care items, and food commodities from retail establishments. This assertion was corroborated by Kantar Worldpanel, which states that the capacity of Filipino millennials to purchase personal and home cleanliness, convenience, and leisure items is expanding (https://business.mb.com.ph/2016/11/19/millennials-purchasing-power-growing-study/).

Background of the Study

The primary impetus for the present investigation was the limited body of scholarship addressing the orientation of Filipino millennials toward the purchase and consumption of luxury brands, with the objective of generating empirical findings for subsequent studies that will contribute a body of knowledge to both business and academic domains.

The effect of the variables examined within the Philippine context remains minimal; the subject area had not been thoroughly investigated at the time the study was conducted.

Significance of the Study

The findings of the research will serve as a scientific foundation for comprehending the brand orientation of Filipino millennials, who constitute approximately one-third of the nation's aggregate population and represent nearly half of the labor force.

Objectives of the Study

The purpose of this investigation is to examine the influence exerted by actual and ideal self-congruity on millennial consumers' brand orientations toward luxury brands. Furthermore, the study examines the effects of materialistic value and status value dimensions in terms of the extent to which they shape millennials' brand orientations regarding luxury brands.

This study aims to contribute to the existing body of knowledge pertaining to young consumers' brand orientations and subsequent purchasing behavior with respect to luxury brands, in order to maximize the commercial potential of this specific target group and to address the precise needs

required to grow sales within this target segment of generation-y consumers among Filipino millennials. The investigation was designed to specifically:

- Determine the motivations among Filipino millennials in their purchase and consumption of luxury brands in terms of actual self-congruity and ideal self-congruity.
- Identify the variables across educational groupings, income categories, gender classifications, and age brackets that significantly influence the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials.
- Determine the effect of materialistic value, status value, and social desirability scale outcomes on the purchase and utilization of luxury brands among Filipino millennials.

Statement of the Problem

The present investigation centers on the effects of actual and ideal self-congruity and the manner in which a consumer's self-image and luxury brand-image congruity shape brand orientation regarding luxury brands. The ideal self-image is defined as the manner in which an individual wishes to be or would prefer to perceive themselves, along with the self-concept the individual desires others to associate with them — encompassing attitudes, perceptions, and affect (Ross, 1971; Schenk & Holman, 1980).

Luxury brand consumption exerts a positive influence on the approximation of ideal self-congruity by transmitting the image and symbolic significance of luxury brands, thereby enhancing an individual's aspirational self-image.

Self-concept is of value to the individual; accordingly, individual behavior is directed toward the enhancement of one's own self-concept through the consumption of luxury goods and brands as symbolic vehicles for communicating symbolic meaning to the individual themselves and to others (Grubb & Grathwohl, 1967).

Brand orientation is an essential element in the valuation of brand equity. Brand orientation constitutes an individual's comprehensive evaluation of a brand and is primarily contingent upon consumer perceptions of that brand (Aaker, 1997). Additionally, self-congruity may be employed to explain and predict brand orientation and purchase intention (Sirgy et al., 1997; Helgeson & Supphellen, 2004). Self-identity value, materialistic value, and status value are closely interrelated (Richins & Dawson, 1992; Dittmar, 1994; Webster & Beatty, 1997).

The research questions guiding this investigation are as follows:

- To what extent are Filipino millennials motivated in their purchase and consumption of luxury brands in terms of actual self-congruity and ideal self-congruity?
- What is the effect of materialistic value and status value on the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials?
- Which variables across educational groupings, income categories, gender classifications, and age brackets significantly influence the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials?
- Which items demonstrate significant correlations with the purchase and consumption of luxury brands among Filipino millennials?

Methodology

The purpose of this investigation is to examine the influence of actual and ideal self-congruity in shaping orientations toward luxury brands. The study employs descriptive research design, which aims to investigate the relationships among variables in the Philippine context. A survey instrument was utilized for data collection. Data were obtained through a questionnaire and subsequently standardized to facilitate comparison. The study drew upon both primary and secondary data sources. Primary data were collected to address the research questions and fulfill the research objectives. The questionnaire comprised closed-ended items with pre-established response options, with no open-ended items included. As a result, the questionnaire is highly structured, with respondents' own words held to a minimum.

To operationalize the distinction between luxury and non-luxury brands, a selection of well-known brands in the Philippines was presented to respondents at the outset of the questionnaire, enabling them to identify a brand as a reference point for subsequent items. The study employed a Likert Scale ranging from 1 to 5, spanning from strongly disagree to strongly agree. A shortened version of the Crowne-Marlowe social desirability scale (Crowne & Marlowe, 1960) was additionally administered to assess the extent to which respondents are concerned with social approval, given that social desirability bias is recognized as one of the most prevalent biases affecting survey research outcomes (King & Bruner, 2000). Lower scores on this scale may indicate that the respondent is less preoccupied with social approval and is more inclined to respond to survey items truthfully and to represent themselves accurately (Crowne & Marlowe, 1960).

The study's respondents comprised Filipino millennials drawn from a higher education institution, as well as young entrepreneurs, employees, employers, and graduates who consume luxury brands. This population was selected because it corresponds to the specific group of interest. The sample consisted of 134 respondents, a size considered sufficient to satisfy the requirements of efficiency, representativeness, reliability, and flexibility — the criteria of an optimal sample, according to Kothari (2004).

A non-probability convenience sampling approach was adopted, premised on the ease of obtaining responses. The study combines self-selection sampling with convenience sampling. The questionnaire was disseminated through the assistance of on-the-job training students and alumni serving as enumerators.

Data Analysis

Analysis of the data obtained from the survey questionnaire was conducted using SPSS, wherein the collected information was examined through the application of statistical tools. Descriptive statistics were employed in particular to describe and numerically compare variables.

Results

Descriptive statistics were first analyzed to generate background information on participants. The hypotheses were tested to verify the relationships between actual and ideal self-congruity in relation to materialistic value and status value, and their reflection in brand orientations toward luxury brands, with reference to non-luxury brands as well. The study collected data from 134 respondents. This section examines the demographic characteristics of the survey sample, alongside the Marlowe-Crowne social desirability scale results.

Frequency Table

Age

	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
18–25	38	28.4	28.4	28.4
26–30	51	38.1	38.1	66.4
35 up	45	33.6	33.6	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

Gender

	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Male	64	47.8	47.8	47.8
Female	70	52.2	52.2	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

Education

	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
Secondary	19	14.2	14.2	14.2
Bachelor	69	51.5	51.5	65.7
Master	10	7.5	7.5	73.1
PhD	5	3.7	3.7	76.9
Other	31	23.1	23.1	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

Income

	Frequency	Percent	Valid Percent	Cumulative Percent
below 15,000	30	22.4	22.4	22.4
15,001 – 30,000	30	22.4	22.4	44.8
30,001 – 50,000	37	27.6	27.6	72.4
50,001 – 75,000	21	15.7	15.7	88.1
75,001 – 100,000	16	11.9	11.9	100.0
Total	134	100.0	100.0	

The sample was composed of 47.8% (64) male respondents and 52.2% (70) female respondents. With respect to educational attainment — whether currently enrolled or reflecting the highest degree obtained — the sample comprised 51.5% (69) Bachelor's degree holders, 7.5% (10) Master's degree holders, 3.7% (5) doctoral degree holders, 14.2% (19) secondary-level respondents, and 23.1% (31) other respondents. The age range of the sample extended from 18 to 37, with a median of 25 and a mean of 27.5. The gender distribution is reasonably balanced, though the sample includes a notable proportion of respondents who have attained or are pursuing a master's degree. The age range is likewise adequate, representing millennial consumers across varying age groups. Income levels were not particularly elevated, as the majority of respondents were full-time students; accordingly, income data were not incorporated into the analysis.

The Marlowe-Crowne social desirability scale results are presented in the table below. A greater number of responses were recorded in the socially desirable category, suggesting that survey results should be relatively dependable and that respondents are, in particular, oriented toward social desirability in their questionnaire responses.

Question:	**T**	**F**	**Sum of total answers:**
a) I have never intensely disliked anyone.	88	46	Socially Undesirable: 240 / 25.58%
b) Sometimes feel resentful when I don't get my way.	50	84	
c) Always careful about my manner of dress.	114	20	Socially Desirable: 698 / 74.42%
d) If I could get into a movie without paying and be sure I was not seen, I would probably do it.	17	117	
e) I don't find it particularly challenging to get along with loudmouthed, obnoxious people.	66	68	
f) I sometimes think when people have a misfortune, they only got what they deserved.	32	102	
g) I am sometimes irritated by people who ask favors of me.	7	127	

Table: Marlowe-Crowne Social Desirability Scale Results

ASCL – Actual Self Congruity on Luxury Brand

ASCLN – Actual Self Congruity on Non-Luxury Brand

ISCL – Ideal Self Congruity on Luxury Brand

ISCLN – Ideal Self Congruity on Non-Luxury Brand

Descriptive Statistics

	Minimum	**Maximum**	**Mean**	**Std. Deviation**
ASCL	7	15	11.78	2.179

	Minimum	Maximum	Mean	Std. Deviation
ASCLN	5	15	12.07	2.511
ISCL	7	15	11.97	2.278
ISCLN	5	15	11.73	2.636

ISCL (mean = 11.97) exceeds ASCL (mean = 11.78): respondents' orientations toward the purchase and consumption of luxury brands are more strongly driven by ideal self-congruity than by actual self-congruity.

ASCLN (Mean = 12.07) exceeds ISCLN (Mean = 11.73): respondents are motivated to purchase and consume non-luxury brands on the basis of actual self-congruity rather than ideal self-congruity.

Mean values for the variables across different age groups

AGE	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	12.21	29.11	12.37	12.34	12.11	22.18	11.53
2	11.51	27.61	11.86	11.75	11.41	21.80	11.06
3	11.71	27.87	12.04	11.91	11.78	21.58	11.11
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Across all variables, the 18–25 age bracket recorded the highest mean values, indicating that this group is most strongly motivated in the purchase and consumption of both luxury and non-luxury brands on the basis of actual and ideal self-congruity. Members of this cohort also assign greater weight to materialistic values, social values, and social desirability relative to other age brackets.

Mean values for the variables across different gender groups

GENDER	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	11.98	30.53	12.36	12.20	11.92	24.09	12.08
2	11.59	25.91	11.80	11.76	11.56	19.77	10.41
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Male respondents surpassed females across all variables. Males are more strongly motivated in the purchase of luxury brands on the basis of both actual and ideal self-congruity relative to females. They assign greater importance to materialistic (functionality), social (prestige, image, reputation), and social desirability values than females; notably, both gender groups converge in agreement across all variables.

Mean values for the variables across different education groups

EDUC	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	11.84	26.11	11.79	11.95	11.47	18.53	10.16
2	11.70	28.64	12.07	11.97	11.62	22.74	11.43

EDUC	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
3	12.40	26.60	12.50	12.20	12.10	22.30	11.10
4	11.40	32.40	12.20	11.80	11.80	26.80	12.80
5	11.77	28.00	12.06	11.94	12.00	20.90	11.13
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Respondents with master's degrees recorded the highest mean values in ASCL, ASCLN, ISCL, and ISCLN, while doctoral degree holders registered the highest mean values in materialistic value, social value, and the social desirability scale.

Respondents with master's degrees are most strongly motivated to purchase and consume luxury brands on the basis of actual and ideal self-congruity. Doctoral degree holders, on the other hand, are most strongly motivated by materialistic value, social value, and the social desirability scale.

Mean values for the variables across different income groups

INCOME	ASCL	MTV	ASCLN	ISCL	ISCLN	SV	SDR
1	11.73	25.20	12.20	12.23	11.90	18.30	10.00
2	12.07	28.77	12.33	12.20	12.07	22.67	11.47
3	12.05	30.73	12.51	12.30	12.11	24.03	12.08
4	11.14	29.19	11.05	11.24	10.90	23.05	11.71
5	11.50	24.94	11.63	11.25	11.00	20.25	10.31
Total	11.78	28.12	12.07	11.97	11.73	21.84	11.21

Respondents in the income brackets of 15,000–30,000 and 30,001–50,000 demonstrated elevated motivation with respect to the purchase and consumption of both luxury and non-luxury brands on the basis of actual and ideal self-congruity relative to other income brackets.

The response patterns concerning materialistic value, social value, and the social desirability scale as motivations for purchase and consumption placed the income brackets of 30,001–50,000 and 50,001–75,000 at the higher mean value positions.

Middle-income earners among Filipino millennials exhibit greater motivation to purchase and consume luxury brands, placing heightened emphasis on functionality, image or prestige, and the social desirability or acceptance associated with product purchase and consumption.

ANOVA Age

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL	5.489	1.159	.317
MTV	26.577	.726	.486
ASCLN	2.802	.441	.645
ISCL	3.999	.768	.466
ISCLN	5.309	.761	.469

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
SV	3.830	.121	.886
SDR	2.704	.616	.542

No statistically significant value was observed based on age.

ANOVA Gender

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL	5.313	1.120	.292
MTV	712.666	22.759	.000
ASCLN	10.461	1.668	.199
ISCL	6.650	1.285	.259
ISCLN	4.448	.638	.426
SV	624.608	23.345	.000
SDR	92.554	25.056	.000

Gender demonstrates significant value in relation to materialistic value, social value, and social desirability as motivations for purchase and consumption. As reflected in the mean values, males are more strongly motivated to purchase and consume on the basis of materialistic value, social value, and social desirability.

ANOVA Education

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL	1.282	.264	.900
MTV	52.690	1.466	.216
ASCLN	.857	.132	.970
ISCL	.180	.034	.998
ISCLN	1.422	.200	.938
SV	104.184	3.594	.008
SDR	9.371	2.228	.070

As indicated in the table, education as a variable demonstrates no significant value in relation to any variables, with near-significant values observed for social value and social desirability. As respondents attain higher levels of education, social value and social desirability tend to play a more prominent role in purchase and consumption behavior.

Income demonstrates significant value in relation to materialistic value, social value, and social desirability. As income rises, respondents are increasingly motivated to purchase and consume on the basis of functionality, prestige, and social acceptance.

ANOVA Income

	Mean Square	F	Sig.
ASCL *	3.772	.790	.534
MTV *	176.612	5.504	.000
ASCLN *	8.746	1.404	.236
ISCL *	6.794	1.322	.265
ISCLN *	8.096	1.171	.327
SV *	161.124	5.918	.000
SDR *	23.051	6.094	.000

Correlations

S.N.	Variables	1	2	3	4	5	6
1	ASCL						
2	MTV	0.16					
3	ASCLN	.891**	0.12				
4	ISCL	.876**	0.15	.927**			
5	ISCLN	.872**	0.12	.942**	.899**		
6	SV	0.14	.893**	0.11	0.14	0.10	
7	SDR	0.09	.954**	0.06	0.08	0.06	.948**

***. Correlation is significant at the 0.01 level (2-tailed).*

ASCL is associated with ASCLN, ISCL, and ISCLN. The motivation to purchase and consume luxury brands on the basis of actual self-congruity is related to ideal self-congruity orientations toward both luxury and non-luxury brands, as well as to actual self-congruity regarding non-luxury brands. The purchase and consumption behavior of Filipino millennials is interrelated across luxury and non-luxury contexts, and across actual and ideal self-congruity orientations. Significantly, since materialistic value is correlated with social value and social desirability, the respondents' responses indicate that they are highly motivated in their acquisitions and consumption on the basis of functionality, prestige/image/reputation, and social desirability/acceptance.

Conclusion

The following conclusions were derived from the investigation:

- Filipino millennials' orientations in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands are more strongly driven by ideal self-congruity than by actual self-congruity. Marketers should take into account that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and

consumption of luxury brands on the basis of ideal self-congruity: they would like to see themselves reflected in the luxury brand; they would like individuals whom they admire to consume the luxury brand; and they would like to be associated with those who consume luxury.

- Filipino millennials' orientations in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands are more strongly driven by ideal self-congruity than by actual self-congruity. Marketers should take into account that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands on the basis of ideal self-congruity: they would like to see themselves reflected in the luxury brand; they would like individuals whom they admire to consume the luxury brand; and they would like to be associated with those who consume luxury.
- Filipino millennials' orientations in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands are more strongly driven by ideal self-congruity than by actual self-congruity. Marketers should take into account that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands on the basis of ideal self-congruity: they would like to see themselves reflected in the luxury brand; they would like individuals whom they admire to consume the luxury brand; and they would like to be associated with those who consume luxury.

Recommendation

Marketers should take into account that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands on the basis of ideal self-congruity. Accordingly:

- The luxury brand should be relatable, consistent, and in alignment or agreement with the consumer's ideal self.
- Marketers should consider endorsers, models, and advertising themes or slogans that accord with the ideal self of Filipino millennials, emphasizing functionality, image/reputation, and social desirability in promotional strategies, packaging, and distribution channels that are perceived as high-end and prestigious.

The orientations of Filipino millennials in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands are more strongly driven by ideal self-congruity than by actual self-congruity.

- Marketers should take into account that Filipino millennials are motivated in the purchase and consumption of luxury brands on the basis of their ideal self-congruity: they would like to see themselves reflected in the luxury brand; they would like individuals whom they admire to consume the luxury brand; and they would like to be associated with those who consume luxury.

One additional limitation of this investigation pertains to the absence of open-ended questions, which would have enabled respondents to articulate and elaborate upon their perspectives in greater depth. Such items would have contributed to a more thorough comprehension of the underlying determinants of luxury consumption; however, many responses might have proven tangential to the specific luxury value perceptions under examination, given that several other relevant perceptions could also have been investigated. It was therefore determined not to include open-ended questions so as to avoid rendering the survey excessively lengthy.

An alternative research method could have been employed through the conduct of a qualitative study to obtain broader insights into the phenomenon, allowing respondents to express their perspectives more freely. This could have been integrated with a survey questionnaire designed in response to the findings of the qualitative study, focusing on the most pertinent aspects of the phenomenon and potentially generating new avenues for future investigation.

Luxury brand consumption is a substantial and expanding phenomenon that warrants more detailed investigation, thus presenting numerous opportunities for the advancement of research in this domain.

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